

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

Q

Why should most vegetables be blanched before freezing?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To stop enzyme activity that causes loss of flavor, color, and texture during freezing

FUN FACT

Blanching preserves the quality of frozen veggies by stopping enzymes quickly!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

Q

What is freezer burn?

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Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Dehydration and oxidation damage caused by air exposure, leading to tough, dry spots and off-flavors

FUN FACT

Freezer burn isn't dangerous, but it makes food taste bad and lose texture.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

Q

Which packaging method helps reduce freezer burn and oxidation in frozen seafood?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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ANSWER

Vacuum sealing to remove air before freezing

FUN FACT

Vacuum sealing keeps frozen food fresh longer by trapping out air!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

Q

Why is it important to leave space at the top of containers when freezing liquids like juices or soups?

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ANSWER

Because liquids expand as they freeze and need room to avoid breaking the container

FUN FACT

Water expands about 10% when it freezes, so always leave some headspace!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Which kind of foods generally do NOT freeze well?

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ANSWER

Foods with high water content like lettuce, cucumbers, and watery fruits

FUN FACT

High-water foods get mushy when thawed because ice crystals destroy their structure.

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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What temperature should your freezer be kept at for safe food storage?

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ANSWER

0°F (-18°C) or below

FUN FACT

Keeping your freezer at 0°F stops bacteria from growing and keeps food safe!

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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Q

How does blanching help preserve the color and flavor of frozen vegetables?

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ANSWER

By stopping enzymes that cause spoilage and color changes

FUN FACT

Enzymes stay active even when cold, so blanching stops them like pressing pause!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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What is the best way to package seafood for freezing to maintain flavor and quality?

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ANSWER

Wrap tightly in plastic wrap, then put in a heavy-duty freezer bag and remove as much air as possible

FUN FACT

Air causes oxidation and freezer burn, so removing it protects seafood quality!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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Q

Why is it important to label frozen food packages with dates?

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Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To know how long the food has been stored and prevent waste

FUN FACT

Labeling helps you use older foods first and saves money by reducing waste!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

What is a good humidity condition for root vegetables stored in a root cellar?

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ANSWER

High humidity around 90-95% to keep them from drying out

FUN FACT

Moist air stops root veggies like carrots from shriveling while in storage!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide

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Why should root vegetables like potatoes and carrots be stored separately or with ventilation in cold storage?

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Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Because potatoes produce gases that cause carrots to become bitter and apples to develop off-flavors

FUN FACT

Some fruits and veggies release gases that spoil others-store wisely!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Teens (14–18)

Q

How soon should perishable foods be refrigerated after purchasing or preparation?

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Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Within two hours (or one hour if above 90°F outside)

FUN FACT

Bacteria multiply fast at room temperature, so chill quickly to stay safe!

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food

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Q

What effect does air trapped inside freezer packaging have on frozen food?

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ANSWER

It promotes oxidation and freezes slowly, creating large ice crystals that damage texture

FUN FACT

Removing air means less ice damage and better texture after thawing!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

To prevent glass jars from breaking when freezing liquids, what should you do?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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ANSWER

Leave at least half an inch of headspace for expansion

FUN FACT

Water expands as it freezes, so give jars room or they can crack!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

What happens if you try to thaw more frozen fish than you can eat right away?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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ANSWER

It can spoil faster and become unsafe after thawing

FUN FACT

Thawed fish should be used quickly to avoid foodborne illness!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

Why is it better to freeze small portions individually rather than a large block of food?

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ANSWER

So you can thaw only what you need without warming the whole batch

FUN FACT

Freezing small packs saves energy and food by thawing just the right amount!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

Which of the following is true about freezing convenience foods like dough balls or cooked vegetables?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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ANSWER

Cool cooked foods completely before freezing to maintain best quality

FUN FACT

Cooling food before freezing prevents ice crystal damage and keeps texture better.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home

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Q

What is the main reason oxidation damages frozen seafood quality?

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ANSWER

Oxygen reacts with fats and proteins causing off-flavors and color changes

FUN FACT

Oxidation is like food 'rusting'-it spoils taste and look over time.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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How can you protect frozen seafood that has large exposed surfaces like crab or shellfish?

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ANSWER

Freeze unwrapped first, then dip in cold water to glaze with ice coating before bagging

FUN FACT

Ice glaze acts like a shield to protect delicate frozen seafood from freezer burn!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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What is a common indicator that frozen food has been affected by freezer burn?

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ANSWER

Dry, tough, or pale spots with off-flavors and odors

FUN FACT

Freezer burn changes food texture and flavor but doesn't make it unsafe to eat.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood